

Back to Basics: AI-Assisted Graphic Design Fundamentals

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****Quick Reference Tables:****

Color Theory

Color	Hex Code	RGB Values	Contrast Ratio
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Black	#000000	(0, 0, 0)	-
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White	#FFFFFF	(255, 255, 255)	-
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Red	#FF0000	(255, 0, 0)	21:1
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Blue	#0000FF	(0, 0, 255)	21:1
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Green	#00FF00	(0, 255, 0)	21:1
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Typography

Font	Style	Size (px)	Line Height (px)
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Arial	Light	16	24
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Helvetica	Regular	18	28
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Calibri	Bold	20	30
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Layout

Element	Alignment	Spacing (px)	Margins (px)
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Text	Centered	8	16
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Image	Left-aligned	12	24
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Button	Stretched	10	18
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Composition

Element	Placement	Size (px)	Position
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Hero Image	Full-width	800	Top
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Call-to-Action	Centered	200	Middle
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Headline	Left-aligned	40	Top
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Paragraph	Left-aligned	18	Bottom
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Step-by-Step Checklists:

Designing a Brochure

1. **Define purpose**: Clearly identify the brochure's goal and target audience.
2. **Conduct research**: Gather reference images, collect brochures, and study competitors.

3. **Brainstorm ideas**: Create a list of concepts, considering content hierarchy and visual flow.
4. **Sketch wireframes**: Create a 2D representation of the brochure's layout and structure.
5. **Create a visual concept**: Develop a cohesive design that incorporates color, typography, and composition.
6. **Mockup and refine**: Create a digital mockup and refine the design with feedback from stakeholders.
7. **Finalize design**: Deliver a polished and error-free design ready for production.

Designing a Logo

1. **Define the company's identity**: Understand the brand's mission, values, and tone.
2. **Conduct competitor research**: Analyze the logo designs of similar companies.
3. **Brainstorm ideas**: Create a list of logo concepts, considering symbolism, typography, and simplicity.
4. **Sketch and iterate**: Develop a few strong concepts and refine them through iterative design.
5. **Refine the logo**: Refine the design, considering legibility, scalability, and color.
6. **Finalize design**: Deliver a vector-based logo design with a range of color options.

Key Formulas or Frameworks:

The Golden Ratio (ϕ)

$$(1 + \sqrt{5}) / 2 \approx 1.61803$$

The 60-30-10 Rule

- 60% primary color
- 30% secondary color
- 10% accent color

The 7-10-12-15 Rule

- 7-10-12: Column width (w1), gutter (g1), and column padding (p1)
- 15: Column width (w2)

The Brand Pyramid

- Tier 1: Logo
- Tier 2: Color palette
- Tier 3: Typography
- Tier 4: Imagery
- Tier 5: Brand voice and tone

Common Mistakes to Avoid:

1. ****Ignoring color contrast****: Make sure color combinations are accessible and easy to read.

2. **Failing to consider typography hierarchy**: Ensure text is clear, readable, and easy to scan.
3. **Overcrowding the layout**: Balance elements and provide adequate white space.
4. **Not considering image resolution**: Ensure images are clear, sharp, and at the correct resolution.
5. **Not testing for accessibility**: Ensure designs meet WCAG 2.1 guidelines.

Pro Tips:

1. **Develop a design system**: Establish a consistent design language throughout the brand.
2. **Use design tools effectively**: Leverage AI-powered design tools to streamline the design process.
3. **Stay up-to-date with design trends**: Continuously educate yourself on industry trends and best practices.
4. **Experiment with new design techniques**: Continuously push yourself to try new design methods and styles.
5. **Collaborate with other creatives**: Share knowledge and ideas with fellow designers to expand your creative vision.

METADATA: